

Chapter 70 - Part 2

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After interviewing everyone, Xu Qingzhu mentioned the few people she was interested in, then asked Zhou Yi'an for her opinion.

Zhou Yi'an disagreed with her and raised an opposing view about one person whose educational background wasn't very high but whose design work was very innovative.

"Her work carries a heavy imitative style." Zhou Yi'an said: "Given time, plagiarism will probably be exposed."

Xu Qingzhu asked: "Who did she imitate?"

"Don't you think this work is very similar to Su Yao's award-winning piece in Berlin back then? She just changed the color scheme and the shape on the right side." Zhou Yi'an said: "We can't have this kind of opportunistic person. It looks innovative, but actually she's just picking up others' discarded wisdom¹. Sooner or later, problems will explode."

Xu Qingzhu stared at that work, looking at it again and again, but only smiled silently.

Among all the design works, this was her favorite piece.

It seemed there was some kind of inexplicable fate at work.

However, she didn't dwell on it, letting coldness suppress those complex emotions and complicated feelings.

In the end, she chose to listen to Zhou Yi'an's opinion and kept the few people Zhou Yi'an favored.

After handing the list to HR, Xu Qingzhu sat there organizing her things.

Zhou Yi'an suddenly said: "You quite surprise me."

"What?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

"I thought you would choose that person." Zhou Yi'an said: "I've never been one to listen to opinions from people I dislike."

"That's you." Xu Qingzhu said: "As for me, I'll listen to opinions from everyone who seriously gives me advice, especially since I actively asked you."

After she finished speaking, she paused, then looked at Zhou Yi'an. "I don't dislike you, although I know you had a part in the Huayue International matter."

Zhou Yi'an's expression changed slightly, then she laughed lightly. "Then you can really endure things."

"It's not about enduring." Xu Qingzhu said: "I've also set you up once, so we're even."

Only then did Zhou Yi'an remember that at the Liang family banquet before, Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu had worked together to set her up.

Liang Shi was quite crazy back then.

But... she lacked the energy that she liked.

Actually, if you asked Zhou Yi'an to explain what kind of energy it was, she couldn't really say.

But it just felt different.

"Clear about love and hate²." Zhou Yi'an's voice was lazy, carrying a casual, devil-may-care attitude. "If it were me, I would keep seeking revenge."

"Revenge won't make my life better, and I have more important things to do than seeking revenge." Xu Qingzhu said: "If you're trying to introduce yourself to me, I don't think it's necessary. I only need to know your work capabilities. I have a meeting in a bit, I need to go. What about you?"

"Aren't you going to ask me something?" Zhou Yi'an glanced at the door. "Like about Su Meiqi."

"There's nothing to ask." Xu Qingzhu said: "I'm the one who wants to keep her, so I'll bear the consequences. Mainly because I feel..."

She paused, then smiled. "She and I are quite fated, after all, her aunt was the person who almost became my aunt-in-law³. What do you think?"

Zhou Yi'an paused slightly.

They were both smart people—what wasn't there to understand?

Zhou Yi'an smiled, put the pen in her pocket, and shrugged indifferently. "Indeed quite fated."

After that, she remained silent.

Xu Qingzhu remained the same as usual during the subsequent meeting, as if what just happened had no effect on her at all.

Instead, Zhou Yi'an's mind wandered once during the meeting.

Su Meiqi had sent her many messages.

【Sister An'an, want some bubble tea?】

【I'll order you bubble tea, can you please not speak badly of me in front of Sister Xu?】

【Sister An'an, QAQ pitiful.jpg】

【.....】

Zhou Yi'an slacked off during the meeting and replied to her: 【Do you know something?】

Su Meiqi: 【Stunned.jpg, what would I know?】

Zhou Yi'an: 【How do you know Xu Qingzhu?】

Su Meiqi: 【Last time I helped her catch a robber, and we even went up Yunfeng Mountain together.】

Zhou Yi'an: 【Then why did you bring up Teacher Su today?】

Su Meiqi: 【.....I simply wanted to remind you not to betray your teacher and destroy your ancestors⁴.】

Zhou Yi'an: 【.....】

Su Meiqi: 【Mainly I wanted to tell you not to bully your teacher's niece, wuwuwu. It's not easy for a kid to find a reliable job. I've already declared I want to live independently, and my little cubs⁵ in the game are about to starve to death because I can't support them anymore.】

Zhou Yi'an could guess she was talking about those little characters in her game.

Looking at her screen full of "wuwuwu," Zhou Yi'an transferred twenty thousand yuan to her.

Su Meiqi: 【!】

Su Meiqi: 【A goddess fairy! Are there really such beautiful and kind-hearted fairies in this world?】

Su Meiqi: 【When you come to dinner tonight, I'll have Sheng Yu dance for you!】

Zhou Yi'an: 【.....】

Su Meiqi, who sold out her little cousin without any guilt, accepted Zhou Yi'an's transfer and sent five or six emoticons of kneeling in gratitude.

Meanwhile, Zhou Yi'an stared at the screen, deep in thought.

Su Meiqi still doesn't know?

But that also seemed normal.

Su Zhe, Su Meiqi's father, had never publicly disclosed Su Yao's whereabouts over the years. Previously, Su Yao had always been abroad, only occasionally being brought back to the country to stay for a while when her condition was stable.

It was only in recent years that she was truly brought back to the country.

And Su Yao's mental state hadn't completely stabilized either. It only improved somewhat after giving birth to Sheng Yu.

She had even been called Sheng Yu abroad the whole time. After returning to the country, just to be safe, they gave Sheng Yu a new name—Su Yu.

This was the name used at kindergarten.

Su Yao seemed to have disappeared from people's sight for a long time.

But actually, her works kept appearing. Her spiritual talent in design was truly incomparable to anyone.

If not for her designs, Haiwei Jewelry couldn't possibly have grown to become an industry leader in twenty years.

Footnotes:

¹ **Picking up others' discarded wisdom (拾人牙慧)** - A Chinese idiom meaning to repeat or imitate what others have said or done; lacking originality and just copying others' ideas.

² **Clear about love and hate (愛憎分明)** - A Chinese expression describing someone who has clear-cut attitudes about what and whom they like or dislike; having strong principles and not being ambiguous about their feelings.

³ **Aunt-in-law (舅媽)** - The wife of one's maternal uncle; in this context, Su Yao almost married Xu Qingzhu's maternal uncle, which would have made her Xu Qingzhu's aunt-in-law.

⁴ **Betray your teacher and destroy your ancestors (欺師滅祖)** - A Chinese idiom meaning to be disrespectful or disloyal to one's teacher and ancestors; showing ingratitude to those who taught you.

⁵ **Little cubs (小崽崽們)** - An affectionate term in Chinese internet slang, often used to refer to virtual pets, game characters, or anything small and cute that one takes care of.